



Giving an executive update when performance is off track

ARIEL EDITION - PRACTICE / ALIGN / DECIDE

CORE SENTENCES

- Let me separate what is temporary from what is structural.
- I'll focus on the two variances that materially affect the outlook.
- The gap is manageable, but the trajectory needs attention.
- We have contained the immediate risk; the next step is to restore momentum.

WORD BANK / COLLOCATIONS

shortfall

The shortfall is concentrated in two accounts.

track below target

We are tracking 4% below target.

corrective action

Two corrective actions are already under way.

structural

This appears structural rather than temporary.

CHINGLISH -> NATURAL ENGLISH

The sales is not good because some customers have problems.

-> **Sales are tracking below target, mainly due to underperformance in several key accounts.**

We will push the sales team to improve it.

-> **We are working with Sales on two targeted interventions to close the gap.**

I don't agree with you.

-> **Can we pressure-test that assumption?**

QUICK CORRECTION

Not: The sales is not good because some customers have problems.

Use: Sales are tracking below target, mainly due to underperformance in several key accounts.

PHRASE OF THE DAY

Let me separate what is temporary from what is structural.

ALIGN ON OBJECTIVE -> RECOMMEND ACTION -> DEFINE WHEN TO REVISIT